



Ramsey Township Reeve Jim Lowry presents former reeve Margaret Duncan with the Senior of the Year award at the July 8 council meeting. Duncan was honoured for her volunteering efforts in the local community.

Get ready for Christmas in July

Canadian Gardener

By Ed Lawrence



It seems a bit odd to be talking about poinsettias in July since these plants symbolize "Christmas" as much as candy canes and Christmas carols. Their traditional colour is a brilliant red, but they also come in white, pink, striped or marble pink and white and last year I saw my first yellow poinsettia! But some of you may have kept last year's poinsettias growing on and now is the time to start preparing them for this year's holiday display.

Perhaps you have already cut them back. If you did trim them in late May or early June, you will have new growth well on its way. Start to pinch the tips of the new shoots as they show their third pair of leaves for a bushier, fuller plant. Each pinch generally results in two new shoots.

If you haven't cut your poinsettia back, do it now. There will still be time for the plant to fill out and for the bracts to colour up for Christmas. You can cut the stems back as much as halfway — this will encourage new growth and fullness in the plant.

You can leave your plant in its pot and place it out in the garden in full sun. The poinsettia is a native of Mexico and can soak up as much sun as you can give it. The more light it gets, the more vigorous the plant. So leave it out in the garden until late August or early September, but make sure you bring it in before there is any danger of frost at night. In fact, you may want to put the plant out in the daytime as long as the temperatures don't drop below 10 degrees C (50 F) and bring it in at night to be sure it doesn't get touched by frost.

When you bring it in for the winter, do a quick wash of the pot exterior and spray the plant with soap and water, rinsing it with clear water. This discourages any unwanted hitchhikers, such as aphids or white flies. Place it in the brightest window you have — preferably south or west — as close to the glass as possible. Feed the poinsettia with half strength 20-20-20 soluble fertilizer every fourth or fifth watering.

By the first of October, make sure that the plant gets 14 hours of complete darkness every night — there should not be any light at all, not even television light. Put it in a dark closet or cupboard or even a box. In the day, bring it out and put it back in the window for 10 hours. Water as required and continue to fertilize as before. This cycle of complete darkness and bright light is necessary if you want the bracts to begin to colour up.

Continue this light and dark cycle, known as a "short day" cycle, for four to six weeks until you see some colour in the bracts or the flower buds begin to form. The red "petals" of a poinsettia are not actually the flowers at all, but rather the bracts that usually emerge before the flowers. The flowers are the small yellow heads you see in the centre of the red bracts.

Once there are flowers or colour in the bracts, you can relax your vigilant short day cycle and leave the plant in the window all the time to enjoy the splash of colour on gray afternoons. And, by the way, merry Christmas!

MNR announces antlerless deer draw

QUEEN'S PARK — Lanark-Renfrew MPP Leo Jordan recently confirmed changes to the antlerless deer draw which makes the application process for deer validation tags more convenient for hunting enthusiasts.

Hunters under the new system will be able to choose from two different systems to apply for the antlerless validation tags.

"The new system is allowing hunters a more streamlined approach to attaining an antlerless validation tag," Jordan is quoted as saying in a recent press release.

Ontario hunters may obtain their Resident's Deer Licence and enter the Antlerless Deer Draw through the use of a touch-tone or rotary dial phone.

Telephone lines are currently open from 4 a.m. to midnight, and will continue to be open seven days a week until July 31. Hunters using this method will need their 15-digit Outdoors Card number, as well as a valid VISA or MasterCard.

The second system allows hunters to continue applying by the traditional paper process through the purchase of a Resident's Deer Licence or Farmer's Deer Licence at any of the ministry's hunting license issuer outlets.

The Antlerless Deer application is attached to the paper licence which should be completed and mailed to the address on the back. This form must be received by MNR no later than 4:30 p.m. (EDT) Thursday, July 31.

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Sat., July 19
at 10:00 a.m. for
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(Signs) or 5 Mi. N.E. of
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For community news
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SERVICE STOP

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TOWNSHIP OF RAMSAY NOTICE OF PUBLIC MEETING

CONCERNING PROPOSED ZONING BY-LAW AMENDMENT

TAKE NOTICE that the Council of the Corporation of the Township of Ramsay will hold a public meeting on the 5th day of August, 1997, at 7:00 p.m. at the Township Office, to consider a proposed Zoning By-law amendment under Section 34 of the Planning Act.

The proposed Zoning By-law amendment affects land located in part of Lot 12, Concession 10, Township of Ramsay, as shown on the Key Map. This land is presently zoned Institutional (I) in Zoning By-law No. 1545. The property was used as a communications facility. This use has now been removed and the property has been sold. The proposed Zoning By-law amendment will rezone this land to Rural (RU). This change would permit a single family home to be constructed on this property.

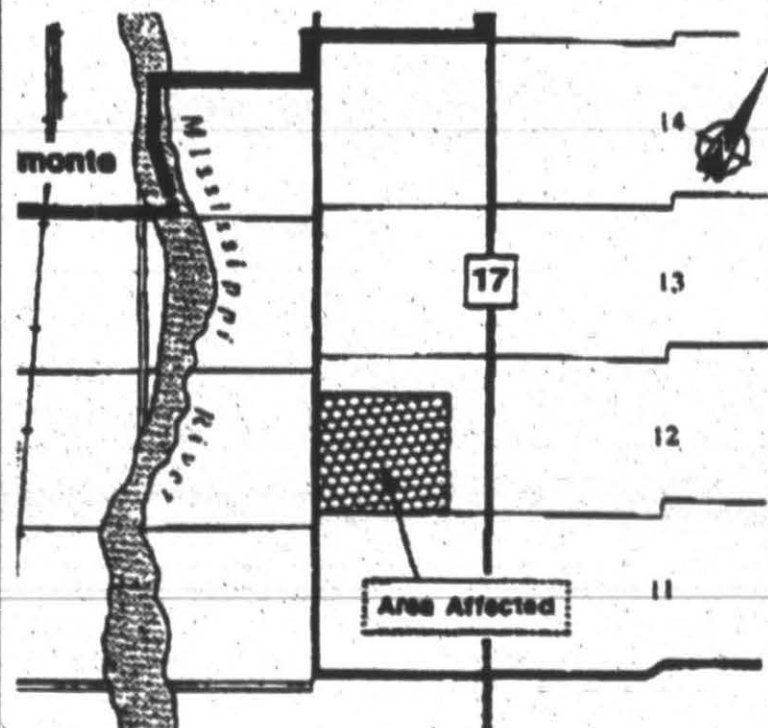
ANY PERSON may attend the public meeting and/or make written or verbal representation either in support of or in opposition to the proposed amendment.

If a person or public body that files an appeal of a decision of the Township of Ramsay in respect of the proposed Zoning By-law does not make oral submissions at a public meeting or make written submissions to the Township of Ramsay before the proposed Zoning By-law is adopted, the Ontario Municipal Board may dismiss all or part of the appeal.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION relating to the proposed amendment is available for inspection at the Township Office during regular office hours.

DATED at the Township of Ramsay this 16th day of July, 1997.

KEY MAP



Ross Trimble, C.A.O.
Clerk-Treasurer
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